

ANSWERS THE COLD WAR

Guiding Question:

What were the main **causes** of the **Cold War**?

Answers from Video:

1. **Disagreements over the future of Eastern Europe and Germany. Stalin wanted Soviet friendly satellite states to serve as a buffer zone. The U.S. pushed for democratic elections and self-determination.**
2. **Stalin distrusted the U.S. use of and access to nuclear weapons.**
3. **Ideological tensions between capitalism and Stalin's brand of communism, which held differing views of the government's role in the economy and overall control in society**

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Yalta and Potsdam conferences
- Percentages Agreement
- Poland elections
- Partition of Germany
- 1948 Czechoslovakia coup
- Iron Curtain

What was **containment**, and how did it shape US Cold War **policy**?

The idea of "containing" communism, using military and/or economic aid, so it did not spread, expressed in the Truman Doctrine

The U.S. used the Marshall Plan to direct \$13 billion in aid to rebuild Europe to undermine the appeal of communism and spread U.S. soft power.

The North Atlantic Treaty Organization (1949) created a military alliance with Western European nations in order to counter the Soviet Bloc, which formed the Warsaw Pact (1955).

Proxy wars developed as the U.S. and Soviet Union fought each other indirectly, believing mutually assured destruction was a deterrent to the use of nuclear weapons. Proxy wars often sought to extend or support each side's influence across the world.

- Long Telegram
- Greek Civil War
- National Security Act of 1947: National Security Council, Department of Defense, and CIA
- Berlin Airlift (1948)
- Korean War (1950-53)
- Vietnam War (1955-1975)
- Soviet-Afghan War (1979-1989)

ANSWERS THE COLD WAR *cont'd***Guiding Question:****Answers from Video:****Additional Evidence/Examples**

How did **decolonization** intersect with the **Cold War**?

As colonies gained independence, the U.S. and Soviets competed to influence or win over the newly independent states. Some African and Asian states formed the Non-Aligned Movement in order to avoid being dominated by either side or pulled into Cold War conflicts.

- Bandung Conference (1955)
- Global South
- Year of Africa (1960)

How did decolonization and the Cold War shape **proxy wars** in Korea and Vietnam?

The U.S. and Soviet Union occupied Korea after WWII, and rival factions emerged during the struggle to reunite the peninsula. When North Korean forces crossed the 38th parallel to conquer the South, the U.S. backed the anticommunist forces in the South, while the Soviets and Chinese backed the communist North. The UN sent in troops led by the U.S., and a stalemate reestablished the 38th parallel as the dividing line between North and South Korea.

- Police action
- Demilitarized Zone (DMZ)
- General MacArthur
- Domino theory

After WWII, Vietnam gained its independence from France after a brief war, but it was divided at the 17th parallel with plans to reunify after elections. North Vietnam established a communist government backed by the Soviets, and South Vietnam established an anticommunist government backed by the U.S.

ANSWERS THE COLD WAR *cont'd*

Guiding Question:

How did the **Vietnam War** come to be a defining conflict for the US?

Answers from Video:

Presidents from Eisenhower to Nixon increasingly escalated the conflict. The Gulf of Tonkin Resolution gave the president virtually unlimited military power in Vietnam, leading to the Americanization of the war with ground troops and bombing campaigns.

Nixon decreased U.S. troops under his Vietnamization plan but increased bombing campaigns, including in Cambodia. U.S. involvement in the war ended under President Ford.

Congress passed the War Power Resolution in 1973 in an attempt to reign in presidential war powers after the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Operation Rolling Thunder
- Ho Chi Minh Trail
- Operation Menu

How did the Cold War shape US policy in **Latin America**?

The U.S. grew concerned about Fidel Castro's Cuban Revolution, seeing his policies as a threat to U.S. interests in Cuba. JFK signed off on the disastrous Bay of Pigs invasion in an attempt to overthrow Castro.

Castro increasingly turned to the Soviets to deter another invasion, leading to the Cuban Missile Crisis, which was ultimately settled diplomatically.

- Guatemala Coup (1954) and civil war
- Support of Contras against Sandinista government in Nicaragua
- Iran-Contra Affair
- US backed coup against Allende in Chile
- Operation Condor: support to anticommunist dictatorships

ANSWERS THE COLD WAR *cont'd***Guiding Question:**

How did the Cold War impact both **global** and **domestic tensions**?

Answers from Video:

The Cuban Missile Crisis demonstrated the real fears of nuclear war. However, the Cold War also experienced periods of détente, when the U.S. and USSR eased tensions through diplomatic agreements and disarmament, like the Strategic Arms Limitation Treaty.

Many in the U.S. grew concerned about the military industrial complex: the close relationship between the federal government and private defense companies.

Fears of the spread of communism contributed to the Second Red Scare and McCarthyism, when Senator McCarthy claimed there were communists in the State Department. While the claims were unfounded, it created a political culture in which any sort of dissent was deemed suspicious.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Nikita Khrushchev
- Helsinki Accords (1975)
- Nixon's visit to China (1972)
- Ping pong diplomacy
- Alger Hiss
- Pumpkin Papers
- Hollywood Ten
- House Un-American Activities Committee
- Federal Loyalty Program

ANSWERS PROSPERITY & CULTURAL UPHEAVAL

Guiding Question:

Answers from Video:

Additional Evidence/Examples

What contributed to a **postwar economic boom**?

Increased consumer spending, particularly on large purchases like cars; The expansion of credit cards also increased consumerism

Government spending in defense industries and the GI Bill, which helped returning vets attend college and finance homeownership

The Federal Aid Highway Act established the Eisenhower Interstate System, easing transportation and spurring the growth of suburbs.

- Growth of middle class
- Labor unions
- Keynesian economics

What were the major effects of **postwar economic growth**?

Rising wages and the development of vaccines led to the baby boom.

Suburbanization increased as cars, the highway system, and lower housing prices through mass production of Levittowns allowed more families to move out of urban areas.

Suburbanization contributed to white flight and redlining, as suburban areas enacted racial covenants, and banks declared minority neighborhoods high risk for mortgage loans.

With rising car ownership and the opening of defense industry jobs, millions of Americans migrated to Sunbelt States in the Southeast and Southwest. This migration redistributed significant economic and political power to the Southeast and Southwest.

- Federal Housing Administration
- Veteran's Administration
- Polio vaccine
- Air conditioning
- Refrigerators
- Washing machine
- Rust Belt
- *Shelley v. Kraemer* (1948): covenants with racial restrictions unconstitutional
- Gentrification
- Swing states

ANSWERS PROSPERITY & CULTURAL UPHEAVAL *cont'd*

Guiding Question:

In what ways did **American culture** become more homogenous in the postwar years?

Answers from Video:

Growth of television and major networks like NBC and CBS that contributed to a mainstream culture, especially with shows that appealed to American values and traditional family lives

Growth of Christian evangelism, especially with televised sermons by ministers like Billy Graham

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Golden Age of Television
- Ed Sullivan Show
- Frank Sinatra
- Disneyland (1955)
- Oral Roberts
- Liberty University
- Conservative Baptist Association of America
- Campus Crusade for Christ

In what ways did various groups challenge **cultural and social homogeneity**?

The Beats rejected consumerism, materialism, and conformity, expressing themselves through literature like Jack Kerouac's *On the Road*.

Intellectuals like John Kenneth Galbraith challenged the idea of widespread prosperity, arguing that consumerism came at the expense of some public goods.

Homosexuals advocated for gay rights through new organizations like the Mattachine Society.

Youth culture pushed back against the conformity of their parents' generation, embracing new cultural trends like rock 'n roll.

- Allen Ginsberg, "Howl"
- Galbraith as expansion of Gilded Age criticism of conspicuous consumption
- *The Other America*, Michael Harrington
- Chuck Berry
- Teenager
- James Dean
- *Rebel without a Cause*
- Dating culture
- Drive-in movies

ANSWERS PROSPERITY & CULTURAL UPHEAVAL *cont'd***Guiding Question:**

How did **youth culture** become increasingly **political**?

Answers from Video:

Through groups like the New Left and Students for a Democratic Society, college students pushed for an expansion of liberalism beyond the New Deal era to address inequality and social injustices, as outlined in the Port Huron Statement.

The Vietnam War radicalized many who opposed the war and the draft, leading to antiwar protests like the March on the Pentagon.

The counterculture, including hippies, rejected conformity, experimenting with drugs and bucking sexual norms.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Weather Underground
- Draft card burning
- 1967 Be-In
- Free Speech Movement
- Kent State shooting
- Woodstock Festival
- Yippies
- Tet Offensive

ANSWERS EXPANSION OF CIVIL RIGHTS**Guiding Question:**

How did the foundational phase of the **Civil Rights Movement** set the stage for its **expansion** in the 1960s?

Answers from Video:

Desire to fulfill promises of Reconstruction, often through grassroots efforts led by CORE and the NAACP and through legal challenges against segregation and discrimination, culminating in *Brown v. Board* and the Civil Rights Act of 1957, which overturned *Plessy* and protected Black voting rights, respectively

Setbacks included the slow pace of school integration, leading to the Little Rock Nine incident, when Eisenhower sent in the National Guard to enforce the *Brown* decision.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- *Smith v. Allwright* (1944)
- Montgomery Bus Boycott
- Emmett Till murder
- Poll taxes
- Grandfather clause

ANSWERS EXPANSION OF CIVIL RIGHTS *cont'd***Guiding Question:**

How did the next phase of the **Civil Rights Movement** build on and intensify the foundational phase while also leading to **divisions about tactics**?

Answers from Video:

Expanded activism using more diverse strategies

Nonviolent protests like Freedom Rides to protest segregation on public transportation

Large marches and protests like MLK's March on Washington and "I Have a Dream" speech

Black Power Movement embraced pride in Black culture and rejected nonviolent methods when ineffective. The Black Panther Party endorsed violence and self-defense when necessary and provided social programs and outreach in Black communities.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Freedom Summer for voting rights in Mississippi
- Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party
- Fanny Lou Hamer
- Sit-in movement
- James Meredith, University of Mississippi
- Student Non-violent Coordinating Committee (SNCC)
- Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC)
- "Letter from a Birmingham Jail"
- Selma March (1965)
- Free Breakfast for Children program
- Parallels to earlier DuBois/Washington split over how to confront racial inequality

ANSWERS EXPANSION OF CIVIL RIGHTS *cont'd***Guiding Question:****Answers from Video:****Additional Evidence/Examples**

How did the **Civil Rights Movement** lead to significant legislative achievements?

The broader Great Society legislation of LBJ sought to address racial and economic inequality.

- Civil Rights Act 1964: legal end to discrimination and segregation
- Voting Rights Act 1965: prohibited racial discrimination in voting and gave federal government power to enforce
- Job Corps: education and job training
- Medicare: healthcare for those over 65
- Medicaid: healthcare for low-income families and individuals

- Head Start (preschool)
- Wilderness Protection Act
- Civil Rights Act 1968
- Food Stamp Act 1964
- Water Quality Act 1965
- Clean Air Act 1963

How did the **women's movement** expand?

Second Wave Feminism focused on social equality, inspired by Betty Friedan's *The Feminine Mystique*, which pushed back on the idea of the traditional housewife.

National Organization for Women pushed for the ratification of the Equal Rights Amendment, which was opposed by Phyllis Schlafly's Stop ERA movement.

Roe v. Wade applied the 14th Amendment and right to privacy to protect the right of pregnant women to choose to get an abortion within certain time constraints.

- The pill (1960)
- Title IX
- Sandra Day O'Connor
- Shirley Chisholm

ANSWERS EXPANSION OF CIVIL RIGHTS *cont'd***Guiding Question:**

How did other **minority groups** advocate for expanded rights?

Answers from Video:

Cesar Chavez founded the National Farm Worker Association to fight for better wages and conditions.

The American Indian Movement sought to reclaim Indian American identity and self-determination while addressing systemic issues. The Self-Determination Act of 1975 gave American Indians greater control over lands, education, and law enforcement.

Emma Gee founded the Asian American Political Alliance to unite people of various Asian backgrounds to work together toward equality and address stereotypes and discrimination.

The gay rights movement gained momentum after the Stonewall Uprising in 1969.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Dolores Huerta
- Chicano Movement
- Wounded Knee Occupation
- Asian American Studies Center in California
- Gay Liberation Front
- Lavender Menace

ANSWERS SOCIETY IN TRANSITION

Guiding Question:

Answers from Video:

Additional Evidence/Examples

What were the main goals of the **New Right/conservative movement**?

Prevent or reverse what they considered to be the moral decline and the challenges to the traditional family structure, evidenced in the counterculture and women's rights movement

Challenge the growth of the federal government, especially in social programs from the New Deal and Great Society

Be more assertive in foreign policy, especially in the Cold War context

- Sharon Statement (1960)
- William F. Buckley, *National Review*

How did the **conservative movement** gain support through the 1960s?

Election of 1964: Barry Goldwater launched the modern conservative movement, attacking social programs and federal overreach

Nixon capitalized on the "silent majority" of Americans who felt disgruntled by the upheaval of the 1960s. He campaigned on "law and order" as a way to target urban areas and push back against civil rights

- Young Americans for Freedom
- The Heritage Foundation
- Milton Friedman
- 1968 Democratic Convention
- Credibility Gap

What were the major **debates** between **liberals** and **conservatives**?

Social and cultural issues like abortion, gender roles

The power of the federal government, especially in civil rights legislation, which the New Right argued violated the 10th Amendment. They also argued that high taxes to fund social programs should be replaced by supply side economics, with tax cuts and deregulation that would provide businesses with extra money to invest and employ more workers

- Pentagon Papers
- Watergate

ANSWERS SOCIETY IN TRANSITION *cont'd***Guiding Question:**

How did **religion** influence **politics**?

Answers from Video:

Growth of Evangelical Christianity fueled conservative political activism as the Christian Right promoted “family values” and opposed abortion and secularism

Jerry Falwell founded the Moral Majority to support candidates who promoted family values.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Televangelism
- Focus on the Family Organization

ANSWERS THE ENVIRONMENTAL MOVEMENT**Guiding Question:**

What caused the rise of the **environmental movement**?

Answers from Video:

Energy crisis, especially in the wake of the 1973 oil embargo initiated by OPEC. This crisis contributed to stagflation and led to the creation of the Department of Energy to explore energy alternatives

Concerns over use of pesticides (DDT) and herbicides, especially during the Vietnam War and outlined in Rachel Carson's book *Silent Spring*

Environmental disasters and concerns over pollution in rivers like the Cuyahoga River; In response, the EPA was created in 1971.

Additional Evidence/Examples

- Earth Day (1970)
- Greenpeace (1971)
- World Wildlife Fund (1961)
- Three Mile Island accident (1979)